



Inspection Report

Patty Talcott Mike Talcott
5425 E CR 400 S
Hardinsburg, IN 47125

Customer ID: **504882**
Certificate: **32-A-0976**
Site: 002
Patty Talcott Mike Talcott

Type: ROUTINE INSPECTION
Date: 12-FEB-2026

2.40(b)(2) Critical

Attending veterinarian and adequate veterinary care (dealers and exhibitors).

A female Australian Shepherd puppy, ID 25-63-17, underwent surgery by the Attending Veterinarian on December 29, 2025 following tail docking that was done outside of the Attending Veterinarian's direction. The licensee stated that they had banded the tail in order to dock it, but the dam apparently pulled off the band and the skin of the tail came off, leaving bone. The licensee stated that upon noticing a piece of the tail bone, the puppy was immediately taken to the veterinary clinic. The Attending Veterinarian stated they had to perform surgery due to the presence of infection and incomplete tail removal. The Attending Veterinarian confirmed that they had not instructed the licensee on how to perform tail docking procedures.

Veterinary medical procedures must be performed according to the Attending Veterinarian's guidance. Conducting procedures outside of the direction of the Attending Veterinarian, such as tail amputations, can result in serious health and welfare concerns, including painful, open wounds.

The license shall establish and maintain programs of adequate veterinary care that includes the use of appropriate methods to prevent, control, diagnose, and treat diseases and injuries.

Corrected prior to the inspection.

2.50(a)(1)

Time and method of identification.

Four adult dogs and three puppies were found without physical identification. The dogs were two adult female Australian shepherds named "Jill," and "Wendy," one black and white female Shih Tzu who was named "Shih-Tzu," and a black and white female Cocker Spaniel named "Cocker." The licensee uses collars and tags as a form of official identification, but none of these dogs had collars on them.

An approved method of identification is necessary for APHIS officials to positively identify animals for inspection and to properly trace their movements.

All live dogs over the age of 16 weeks shall be identified by an official tag affixed to the animal's neck by means of a collar

Prepared By: ALEXANDRA CALDERON
USDA, APHIS, Animal Care
Title: VETERINARY MEDICAL
OFFICER

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or shall be identified by a distinctive legible tattoo marking approved by the Administrator or by a microchip placed under the dog's skin.

Correct by 3/6/26

3.1(c)(3)

Repeat

Housing facilities, general.

The surfaces of the sheltered housing facilities are not being cleaned and sanitized in an appropriate manner. Located along the bottom of two primary enclosure walls and doors was the accumulation of light to dark brown organic debris and dirt. This area of dirt and grime on the walls and doors extended upward approximately 1 ft in height, creating a contrast against the white kennel walls and door. Along the surface of the ceiling and doors were areas of brown spotting consistent with fly feces. The exterior of one shelter in the outdoor housing area was also observed to have excreta panning approximately two thirds of the concrete floor.

The accumulation of dirt, organic debris, and excreta illustrates the lack of proper spot cleaning and sanitization. Improper cleaning and sanitization can increase the risk of contamination and disease.

The licensee must ensure that hard surfaces with which the dogs come in contact are spot-cleaned daily and sanitized in accordance with 3.11(b) to prevent the accumulation of excreta and reduce disease hazards.

3.6(a)(2)(i)

Primary enclosures.

An enclosure housing an adult Australian Shepherd named "Red Bess" and her five puppies has a door in disrepair. The door is made from a corrugated metal panel. It is secured on the front by 3 pieces of wood framing studs located at the top, left and right sides, middle, and bottom of the metal panel. At approximately 4 inches from the bottom left corner of the door, and extending approximately two thirds upward, the door is slit and breaking away from the wood frames creating sharp points and edges.

Sharp points and edges can put the animals at risk for injuries. The opening created by the broken corrugated metal panel could also result in animal escapes and potentially injury from entrapment.

The facility must ensure that primary enclosures are constructed and maintained so that they have no sharp points and edges that could injure the dogs.

Correct by 3/6/26.

3.6(a)(2)(vi)

Primary enclosures.

During the inspection a female blue merle Australian Shepherd puppy, ID 25-67-6, could not open the 'doggy' door to re-enter the sheltered part of the sheltered housing facility on its own. The weather at the time was 40 degrees Fahrenheit.

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The puppy was found vocalizing and sitting just outside the door. It was wet along its abdomen, tail, four legs, and paws. The inspector noted that the dam appeared to be attempting unsuccessfully to guide the puppy back indoors to be sheltered.

Without access to shelter and protection from extreme temperature conditions, a young animal can have trouble in conserving body heat. This can result in the animal succumbing to illness and be in a state of unnecessary discomfort.

Primary enclosures must provide shelter and protection from extreme temperatures and weather conditions that may be uncomfortable or hazardous to all the dogs.

Correct by 3/6/26.

3.13(a)(4)

Veterinary care for dogs.

The licensee is not currently following the veterinary care program which states the owner is to brush coats bi-weekly. An adult black and white female Shih Tzu was acquired a month ago according to the licensee. Her haircoat is dirty and has a disheveled appearance. It is overgrown as pieces of fur frame her face and extend towards her eyes resulting in minor obstruction to vision.

Lack of routine preventive care for a dog's hair coat can result in matted fur and skin issues if not maintained. The facility must follow the preventative care and treatment plan written in their program of veterinary care to ensure a healthy and unmatted hair coat.

Correct by 3/6/26.

This inspection and exit interview were conducted with the facility representative.

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Species Inspected

Cust No	Cert No	Site	Site Name	Inspection
504882	32-A-0976	002	Patty Talcott Mike Talcott	12-FEB-2026

Count	Scientific Name	Common Name
000016	<i>Canis familiaris</i>	DOG ADULT
000014	<i>Canis familiaris</i>	DOG PUPPY
000030	Total	